Red Hat
Ansible Automation
Platform

FEDORA LANE · AUTOMATION BRIEFING

Automating the enterprise foundation

Simple, secure, self-service automation for a global brand, with Red Hat Ansible Automation Platform



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Infrastructure, Security, Linux Engineering & App Dev

Red Hat

Why we're here

Fedora Lane wants to move from fragile scripts and manual tickets to automation the whole team can trust.

TODAY'S OBJECTIVE

Show how Red Hat Ansible Automation Platform makes your automation simple, secure and self-service, and agree on a concrete first step together.

Agenda

01	What we heard Your three automation challenges	3 min
02	The Ansible approach How the platform solves them	3 min
03	Live demo Three capabilities, three challenges	5 min
04	Value & next step What it means for each team	2 min

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A global brand running on a complex hybrid estate



Hybrid by design

VMware data centers in Virginia & Frankfurt, plus server closets in boutiques from Paris to Tokyo.



Multi-cloud

AWS runs global e-commerce across three regions; Azure hosts analytics and selected COTS apps.



Strict compliance

PCI DSS, GDPR and CCPA. Critical/High CVEs patched within 30 days; quarterly audits.



Experience is the brand

Boutiques and the e-commerce platform must deliver a seamless experience, everywhere.

The result today: siloed teams, configuration drift and manual, error-prone operations.

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Three challenges holding automation back

01



Brittle scripts create automation silos

A 500-line Bash script only one admin trusts. A simple disk-size change failed midway, leaving a half-built staging environment.

2 days

to rebuild a routine staging environment by hand

- Casey Novak
- Alex Lee

02



Decentralized automation creates risk

Production AWS keys in a plaintext file. A typo hit the database tier and caused an outage, run from a laptop.

0

audit records of who ran what, where, or why

- Ren Tanaka
- Alex Lee

03



Manual handoffs slow developers

A GitLab project and database access passes through email, ITSM, an admin, a DBA and an approval inbox.

3 days

before a new developer can contribute

- Cameron Shaw

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Automation everyone can read, run and trust

- Today: bespoke Bash, line 214 of 500

```
DB_DISK=${DB_DISK:-40}  # also set on L87?
VOL=$(aws ec2 create-volume --size $DB_DISK \
  --availability-zone ${REGION}a | jq -r .VolumeId)
if [ -z "$VOL" ]; then echo "ERR 17"; exit 17; fi
aws ec2 create-tags --resources $VOL --tags \
  Key=Owner,Value=$OWNER # TODO env tag
sleep 30
aws ec2 attach-volume ... || exit 23
# TODO(mike): cleanup on failure??
```

- With Ansible: describe the desired state

```yaml
- name: Ensure staging database volume
  amazon.aws.ec2_vol:
    name: "fl-{{ env_name }}-db"
    volume_size: "{{ db_disk_gb }}"
    zone: "{{ aws_region }}a"
    modify_volume: true
    tags:
      Owner: "{{ owner }}"
      Environment: "{{ env_tier }}"
```

Need a bigger database disk? It's one clearly named value, and re-running changes only what's different.

Human-readable
Plain YAML anyone on the team can review and contribute to

Idempotent
Safe to re-run; no half-provisioned environments

Agentless
Uses SSH, WinRM and cloud APIs; nothing to install

Certified content
AWS, Azure, VMware, GitLab, ServiceNow and more

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One platform to create, run and govern automation

CREATE

Playbooks in Git

Versioned, peer-reviewed and shared. One source of truth, not files on laptops.

RUN & GOVERN

Automation controller

The central control point for all automation

Credential vault
Secrets encrypted, never exposed

Role-based access
Who can run what, where

Surveys & self-service
Simple forms for any user

Workflows & approvals
Chain teams, one-click sign-off

Job history & audit
Who, what, when, result

Schedules & API
Plug into ITSM and CI/CD

Execution environments: the same tested, containerized runtime everywhere

EVERYWHERE YOU RUN

AWS & Azure — EC2, VPCs, load balancers, RDS

VMware data centers — RHEL fleet in Virginia & Frankfurt

Boutique servers — Reached via automation mesh

GitLab, databases, ITSM — Developer & process tooling

Also in the platform

- Automation hub: certified content
- Event-Driven Ansible
- Automation analytics

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The Ansible approach

How the platform solves each challenge

YOUR CHALLENGE	ANSIBLE AUTOMATION PLATFORM	OUTCOME FOR FEDORA LANE
01 Brittle scripts & automation silos	Readable playbooks + surveys Job templates turn any playbook into a simple, validated form.	→ Anyone on Casey's team can run and contribute safely; failed runs don't leave broken environments.
02 Decentralized risk & blind spots	Credential vault, RBAC, job history Secrets injected at run time; access scoped by team.	→ No keys on laptops, guardrails against wrong-target runs, and audit evidence for Ren and Alex on demand.
03 Slow, manual handoffs	Workflows with approval steps Ops, DBA and owner sign-off in one automated flow.	→ Developer onboarding in minutes once approved; owners approve with one click.

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LIVE DEMO · ANSIBLE AUTOMATION PLATFORM

Here's what you're about to see

01

Self-service staging change

A junior admin resizes a staging database disk through a simple form, and re-runs it safely.

FOR CASEY & ALEX · CHALLENGE 01

02

Secure and audited by design

AWS keys used but never seen, access scoped by role, every run on the record.

FOR REN & ALEX · CHALLENGE 02

03

Developer onboarding in minutes

A workflow creates the GitLab project and grants database access after a one-click approval.

FOR CAMERON · CHALLENGE 03



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What you just saw

01 Simple, powerful automation

YOU SAW

A junior admin changed a disk size through a form. Running it again changed nothing.

WHICH MEANS

Automation no longer depends on one expert, and failures don't leave broken environments.

02 Central control & security

YOU SAW

The AWS key was used but never shown. The junior user could only run approved jobs. Every run was logged.

WHICH MEANS

Secrets off laptops, guardrails on targets, audit evidence on demand.

03 Self-service with approvals

YOU SAW

A developer requested access, the database owner approved in one click, and the platform did the rest.

WHICH MEANS

A three-day handoff becomes a same-day, auditable workflow.

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Value for every team at Fedora Lane

AS

Anya Sharma

Chief Information Officer

BUSINESS VALUE

IT shifts from keeping the lights on to accelerating the customer experience.

TECHNICAL VALUE

One automation platform across data centers, AWS and Azure.

AL

Alex Lee

VP Global IT Infrastructure & Ops

BUSINESS VALUE

Stable operations with a team no longer stretched by manual work.

TECHNICAL VALUE

Central visibility of every automation run on a supported platform.

RT

Ren Tanaka

Head of InfoSec & Compliance

BUSINESS VALUE

Lower PCI DSS and GDPR risk, with far less audit effort.

TECHNICAL VALUE

Encrypted credentials, least-privilege RBAC, logs to your SIEM.

CN

Casey Novak

Head of Linux Engineering

BUSINESS VALUE

The team moves from firefighting to proactive engineering.

TECHNICAL VALUE

Standards enforced as code, safely and repeatably, across the fleet.

CS

Cameron Shaw

VP Application Development

BUSINESS VALUE

Developers productive on day one, not day four.

TECHNICAL VALUE

Self-service resources via forms and API, ready for CI/CD.

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Value

What success could look like

Routine staging environment	~~2 days~~	→	**Under an hour** self-service
New developer access	~~3 days~~	→	**Same day** approval-bound
Credentials on laptops	~~Plaintext~~	→	**Zero** all vaulted
Automation audit trail	~~None~~	→	**Every job** who, what, when
People who can run automation	~~One expert~~	→	**Whole team** with guardrails

Illustrative targets, to be baselined and confirmed together during discovery.

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Recommended next step

PROPOSED

Half-day Automation Discovery Workshop

WHO	Casey's and Cameron's engineering leads, a member of Ren's team, and Red Hat
WHAT	Map your first three workflows: staging environments, developer onboarding, and CVE patching
OUTCOME	A prioritized backlog, agreed success metrics and a pilot plan

30-minute kickoff call · next Wednesday

THE PATH FROM THERE

STEP 1 · NEXT WEEK

Discovery workshop

Agree scope, owners and success metrics.

STEP 2 · ~30 DAYS

Pilot on Ansible Automation Platform

Deliver the three workflows in your environment.

STEP 3 · SCALE

Expand across the estate

ITSM integration, Event-Driven Ansible, Azure, VMware and boutiques.

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Thank you

Questions?

Simple automation your whole team can trust. Central control and audit for security. Self-service that gives developers their time back.



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Security & compliance in depth

Q&A BACKUP



Credentials encrypted at rest

Secrets are encrypted in the controller database and can't be read back through the UI or API. Users run jobs without ever seeing them.



Bring your own vault

Credential plugins look up secrets at run time from HashiCorp Vault, CyberArk, Azure Key Vault and other external secret stores.



Least-privilege access

Organizations, teams and granular roles (admin, execute, use, approve) with SSO via LDAP, SAML or OIDC.



Audit trail

Job history records who launched what, against which inventory and credential, with full output. The activity stream tracks configuration changes.



Guardrails against mistakes

Locked inventories and limits on templates, validated survey inputs, and approval steps before sensitive changes.



Evidence for your SIEM

Stream job and activity events to Splunk, Elastic or other log aggregators for PCI DSS and GDPR audits.

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Integrating and scaling across Fedora Lane

Q&A BACKUP



Start from your ITSM

Certified ServiceNow ITSM content lets requests begin in your existing tool, with tickets updated automatically.



Event-Driven Ansible

Respond automatically to monitoring alerts and events, for example restarting a failed service before customers notice.



Automation mesh

Run automation close to boutique servers and across data centers and clouds, resilient to WAN latency.



Certified & validated content

Supported collections for AWS, Azure, VMware, network and RHEL system roles from automation hub.



Builds on your RHEL standards

Enforce your Activity 1 RHEL baselines, CIS hardening and CVE patching as code, inside the 30-day window.



Measure the value

Automation analytics reports job success rates and time saved, to prove ROI to the board.

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